Worksheet 3.1

Struggling to survive

Student: ..... Class: .....

1. Define the term ‘adaptation’.

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2. Explain how each of the following examples are adaptations for survival.

(a) Desert marsupials excrete small quantities of very concentrated urine.

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(b) Polar bears have a thick fur coat.

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3. Blackberries and cane toads are introduced species in Australia.





Photos:
Blackberries: digifuture/123RF
Cane toad: Hypervision
Creative/Shutterstock.com

(a) Blackberries were introduced to Australia in the 1800s and have spread across the landscape and taken over various habitats. Explain why this plant has successfully outcompeted native species.

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(b) Cane toads were introduced into Queensland to control sugarcane pests. The toad in turn has become a pest and has spread into NSW and the Northern Territory. Explain why the cane toad has been able to invade large areas of land.

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4. The Asiatic black bear constructs beds and platforms in trees and eats nuts, fruits and small animals.



Photo: wildlywise / Shutterstock.com

Describe structural adaptations that the Asiatic bear has in order to survive in its habitat.

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